Spring 2010

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

Volume IX Issue II

President's Pen— Spring 2010

By Jackson Bain

As I write this, the temperature is 89 degrees, I'm in shorts and a t-shirt and it is impossible to remember how cold and snowy we were just two months ago on the Mountainside. But snowy it was, with the heaviest snowfall in decades and the feeling that it might just never stop.

But it did stop, and then your Coolfont neighbors did what they do best: they came out to help.



Jason Geno & family driving up Herbert Quick Drive February 2010

Among our special helping angels was indomitable Hallie Kerr, who kept us all informed by phone and somehow managed to keep most everyone calm as well. Shane Cheatham moved quickly with his Bobcat to help folks get in or get out. John Hobday kept the water system running even if he had to dig below the banks of snow to find the system! And all the rest of you who called to report to your neighbors that all was well—not, and who offered whatever assistance you could provide.



As an Association, we also learned some good lessons about preparing for the unexpected—even though this was a once-in-a-century snow fall that none of us may ever see again..

It taught us that we as a community must always be prepared for the worst—while expecting the best. The work we are doing now to upgrade and renew our water and sewer system is part of that preparation—to make the water supply safe and sound, the system reliable and robust and the folks who manage and maintain it well-trained and guided by clear and consistent procedures.

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Next Phase of Water/Sewer Utility Renewal Has Started

By Jackson Bain

Now that Spring has arrived, the next phase of work on renewal of the Coolfont water system will soon begin. CMA Water Committee members Elmer Broxson, Joe Van Meter, Rick Picardi, Carol Williams and I are working to make certain the renewal work moves quickly, smoothly and efficiently over the good weather month ahead. Our goal has been to deliver a water and sewer system with excellent levels of quality, control and reliability for current and future CMA members.

Recent Accomplishments

Here's what has happened over the past few months:

- The completed "B" section renewal project has been tested and approved. This system also supplies the swimming pool, the CMA office and the barn.

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Calendar of Events

May 15
Board Meeting, CMA office 10a.m.
Pool Clean-Up Day-12 N
Potluck Dinner-6:30 p.m.
The Sophars
72 Hampton Grove Drive

May 28
Pool Opens

May 28-31
Art Walk

May 30
Pool Party

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June 12
Board Meeting, CMA office 10a.m.
Potluck Dinner-6:30 p.m.
Michael & Cathy Levey-A-6

June 13
Newcomers Brunch
The Barn

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July 4
Pool Party

July 10
Board Meeting, CMA office 10a.m.
Potluck Dinner-6:30 p.m.
Martha Ashelman-D-5

Next Phase of Water/Sewer Utility Renewal Has Started

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The sewer renewal system is now fully operational: there is an aerating fountain installed in the lagoon and a double ultraviolet sanitation device treating all outflow from the wetlands to Sir John's Run.

Current Planning Underway::

Today, the engineers are working on the scope of work for Phase II—the renewal of the D, F, G and I sections and the connection of the North Reservoir to the South Reservoir for emergency additional water supply. Our focus has been to replace the known problem area primarily those older areas with old black pipe that is prone to leaks.

Will Water Meters Need to be Moved?

You may have heard the original discussion about the possibility of having to move homeowners' water meters in those sections receiving the new main lines. In meetings with the engineers, we were able to avoid those changes, but we **urge homeowners in the F, G and I sections to consider replacing their very old black pipe from the meter to their homes anyway, while this construction is taking place.**

The black pipe has long outlived its usefulness, and leaks on your side of the meter could be very costly and still drain our reservoirs. If you don't know what kind of pipe you have, ask CMA Operations Manager John Hobday or a reputable plumber familiar with our systems. It's easy to see the line inside your water meter housing.

Additional Engineering Tasks:

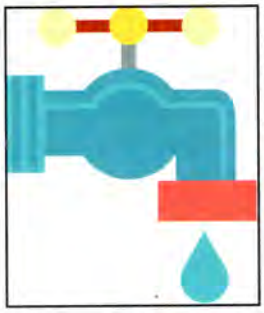
The engineers are also working on a method of upgrading our electrical systems and controls to make those controls more robust and less prone to failure.

In addition, the engineers are reviewing data on the other sections to make certain main lines in other sections such as E, K and L are not suffering high leak levels. If found, we will replace additional main lines where recurring leaks are discovered.

You may remember when 18 major leaks were found and identified in the Fall of last year using leak detection equipment and GPS technology. Those lines have been repaired, and our current water loss numbers reflect that repair, as will the installation of the new "B" section system.

Finally, we will have a written system management program that guides maintenance, monitoring, scheduled replacement of parts (before they fail), protocol for regulatory response, emergency management and response—and general good housekeeping for the water lifeline of this community.

We'll keep you updated on the progress frequently on the website and on the www.cma-mem-



No more leaky pipes.

Conserve water.

Recreation News—Trails, Pools and Playground

By Jason Geno

It's time for Spring cleaning-which also pertains to our trails at CMA. We are attempting to find a suitable date for clean-up of the White Trail. It looks like Saturday, May 22 may be the best date. Those interested and able to move small tree limbs and use a shovel should email me Jeg1568@gmail.com with their availability.

Having a hard time finding a seat at the pool? I will be purchasing additional lounge chairs for the pool area for opening day-so come enjoy our beautiful pool.

We are also adding more equipment for family fun at the playground area (a.k.a. the magic meadow) items we are considering are: teather ball and soccer goals. Stay tuned-more information to come!



President's Pen

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Of course, we live in a rural, mountainous community and our own expectations must adjust to that real sometimes rough—environment. We don't have an urban sanitation or water system, and often, the gravel roads to which they connect: paved roads cause massive water runoff that damages the environment—and often, the gravel roads to which they connect. We have all chosen "rustic" over "suburban", because we love the look and feel and smell of the deep mountain forest in which we all share stewardship.

Are you a good steward? I'll bet you are, since you're a CMA member reading this newsletter. Thank you for being on this mountainside, for your volunteerism (we need you!) and for enjoying with the rest of us this natural environment—and its sometimes bothersome weather.

Best,

Jackson



Rustic over suburban

First Impressions

By Cathy Levey

Snow falls covering everything in a soft coating of brilliant white. Suddenly everything is cloaked in an astonishing silence. The sun rises, reflecting on every snow covered surface, creating the illusion of a million tiny diamonds. In the morning the silence is broken by the cacophony of the rat-tat-tat of brilliantly colored pleated woodpeckers flying from tree to tree for a morning breakfast. Finally, the snow melts and the warmth of spring brings a new gentleness. As if on cue, a flurry of chipmunks erupts from the ground and burst into dance and play, celebrating yet again the renewal of life. Standing outside each day, we sense the deep loving light-filled spirit that fills this place called Coolfont. We never tire of the gratitude we feel at having a chance to live in such a God-graced place as Coolfont.



A hungry pleated woodpecker

This is what brought Michael and I here as tourists and inspired us to move here in November as full-time members of the community. The community itself had initially factored very little in our decision to move here and this was a mistake indeed. What we have discovered is a vibrant community run by a relatively small group of dedicated volunteers. We have met a board president who runs the meetings with a strong and sincere sense of respect and civility as well as a clear intelligence and openness to the community. We have discovered a number of community members who have dedicated themselves to a variety of volunteer activities despite personal hardships such as loss of loved ones and health crises. We have witnessed repeatedly a general sense of patience, grace and good humor. Even when others are not on their best behavior, as well as a genuine sense of compassion for fellow members who are struggling with personal challenges. Finally, we have been welcomed with a generosity of heart. We are completely taken aback by the power and grace of our new community. It is a little like falling in love.

New Website and Google Groups for CMA Members

By Liz Dane

After Jackson Bain took on the role of President of CMA, he immediately recognized the need to increase our communications with our members and guests of CMA.. He reviewed our current website and called upon member Liz Dane (G5, Inn 2 the Woods) to assist him in working with a web designer to explore the options of developing a new CMA website for CMA.

Liz and Jackson met with a company in Alexandria and came to the determination that we have a great website that member Bob Borchers, designed for us! The site just needs a bit of "jazzing up with more graphics and the ability for members to interact. The goal is to have a website that serves the needs of both our members and those who are interested in our community to rent or purchase a home at Coolfont.

They presented their recommendations to the Communications Committee headed up by Lois Copeland. The committee agreed that the website should have input from the community to find out what the members of the CMA would like to see in their website.

Take a look at our current website: http://newsite.coolfontmountainside.org and tell us what you like and don't like about the site. Look for an upcoming electronic survey in your e-mail asking for your input.

We look forward to hearing from you.

Join Our Google Group
Check Out Our Web Site

A Reminder from DACC

By Flo Merola

Owners, their guests and their tenants are asked to give high priority to preservation and enhancement of natural terrain and natural plant growth especially large and well preserved specimens like dogwood, redbud and mountain laurel.

DACC (Development & Architectural Control Committee) is concerned with the general environment of the community in regards to design, structure and maintenance of property and construction of new houses.

In light of our committee responsibility we want to remind homeowners that no trees over six inches in diameter may be cut, topped or trimmed on any lot or on common ground unless DACC grants permission. Requests to remove trees that pose a danger will be reviewed (and approved) by DACC. Owners may, however, remove trees without approval that are located within 10 feet of any house or less than six inches in diameter. Please contact Flo Merola with any questions or concerns.



Eastern Redbud

Swimming Pool Update

By Bob Cohen

The CMA swimming pool will open on Friday, May 28th, weather permitting. We have renewed our agreements with Emily Hornbaker and Meladie Thomas to provide life guard service. A third person will be employed as backup.

Last week, our pool contractor, Jeff Allen lifted the pool cover and examined the pool He found it to be in great shape with the water intact from last year's season. This year we won't have to worry about draining the reservoirs to fill the pool. The "chemicalization" needed to pass Health Department inspection will begin a couple of weeks before opening.

New items for this year include: a bubbler for the hot tub, some new pool furniture, and the placement of yellow jacket traps to catch the insects before they catch us. We plan to work on repairing the flagstone deck before opening. This will take a few seasons to complete. In addition, we expect to trim back some trees around the pool to allow more sunlight to heat the black (really, grey) surface of the pool. We will get approval from the DACC committee first. This should allow us to keep the pool warm without using as much propane.



Join us for our summer holiday barbeques

On May 15th, there will be a pool clean-up day. All CMA members are invited to come to the pool to clean leaves and plant flowers so that the pool will look its best by opening day. On Sunday, May 30th we are planning to have our annual barbeque at the pool. Remember—we will provide hotdogs, hamburgers, sodas and beer. You might think about what else you may contribute.

Tari's A Berkeley Springs Landmark

By Lois Copeland

My family and I discovered Tari's March 2000 when we rented a house at Coolfont. We walked into Tari's and were immediately dazzled by their décor and gallery setting. Of course, we couldn't resist, once seated, walking around and admiring the art and jewelry. We laughed at Jonathan Heath's paintings, struck by Jan Heath's prints and loved the pottery and handcrafted jewelry.

The restaurant opened its' doors in 1989 by Tari Hampe-Deneen and her husband Lovey. Since then Tari's has been a "must go place" when in Berkeley Springs.

In 2006 Tari and her husband retired and passed on Tari's to their long time employee Amy Mcbee. They maintain the high standards Tari set-using fresh, many times home-grown food, preparing imaginative and original meals and high lighting local artists.

Now the food, it's excellent whether you come in for lunch, a drink or dinner. I can honestly say I've never had a bad



meal or a disappointing dining experience at Tari's. Their lunch menu is extensive whether you want something light or hearty sandwich. You must try their soups, especially the tomato soup, perfectly seasoned and hearty. I usually order their panani sandwich—done just right.

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WHY NOT RUN FOR THE CMA BOARD THIS YEAR?

By Rusty McCrady

Yes, it's already time to start thinking about whether you would like to become a member of the CMA Board of Directors. The election will be held next fall. Any time during the next couple of months, you can nominate yourself or someone else to run for one of the three positions that will be open next year.

Elections will be conducted by mail next September and finalized at the Annual CMA Meeting in October. So let me know soon if you wish to run or wish to nominate someone else.





You can make a difference!

Tari's A Berkeley Springs Landmark

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Now onto dinner. Even the pickiest eater will find something delicious on this menu. Jay, my husband, usually orders the seaweed salad, Amy, our daughter, a steak lover always orders their steak frites or filet mignon., done perfectly. My favorites are the glazed salmon or the seared scallops. Our vegetarian Edward also finds choices on the menu, if not the chef customizes one of their vegetarian offerings.

To top off the dinner, one can't forget dessert. The server brings around the dessert tray where every sweet morsel says try me, try me! If you feel one dessert is too much, get one for the table.

Diners' have three rooms to choose from—the Gallery, Café and Tavern. Each with their own atmosphere but the same delicious menu. No matter what room you choose, Tari's has an extensive beverage menu, including domestic and imported beers and wines and mixed drinks.



Five Stars!

In addition to the amazing art and excellent food and drink, the staff is attentive, friendly and quite interesting.

No matter whether you are a full time resident, part time resident or a guest visiting Berkeley Springs, dining at Tari's is a must. Lots to see, lots to drink, and lots of great food to eat. It rates five stars!

Open seven days a week, 11am till 9pm. Call ahead on weekends 304-258-1196. 33 North Washington Street, right in the heart of Berkeley Springs.

New Technology on the Mountainside Remote and Automation Information

By Ron Wohl

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Using technology to make your mountainside home more livable and accessible is a good thing. Technology can add to the security of your home and to your comfort and enjoyment. Recently, I have been asked about using technology to provide remote settings for heating and cooling and to receive alerts in the event something goes awry. This article deals with devices you an add to your home, generally at a very affordable cost, to increase your livability.

One device can be installed around your water heater or other water using appliances to alert you to leaks or floods and even call you to tell you there is a problem. There are several manufactures of these alert systems. One of these is made by Reliance Controls and can be seen at relaincecontrols.com/product Detain.aspx?THP201. this unit sells for less and $100 and is easy to install. The web site shows video to take you through installation and programming.

Suppose you want to raise or lower your heating and cooling system from a remote location, Radio Shack sells state of the art home automation.



Don't go From < this To this >



911—IF YOU CALL WILL THEY FIND YOU?

By Arnie Weinberg

If there is an emergency at your home in Coolfont and you call 911, will the EMS be able to find your house?

911 Emergency Services uses GPS to find location of the emergency call. If you are the owner of one of the forty-eight (48) houses on the Mountainside that does not have the house number mounted at the end of the driveway, THEY MAY NOT.

If you own one of these houses, do not put yourself or your family at risk. CMA has your house number. Call Shane Cheatham at 304-258-2984 for pick-up or installation.



The EMS can find my house, but can they find yours, says Lois Copeland?

Coolfont Mountainside Association

coolfontmountainside.org

CMA
P.O. Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Jackson Bain, President
703-619-0556, 304-258-6257
Jackson@bainpr.com

Lois Copeland, Editor
301-530-1115, 304-258-8127
locopeland@aol.com

Bits of News

*Welcome to

Mitchell & Leslie Ann Swerbilow who recently bought K-15.

*Remember the **Farmer's Market** is open every Sunday from 10-2. Support your local farmers.

*Look for information on the upcoming **Berkeley Springs Art Tour** Memorial Day Weekend.





Looks like what?

Two different views.

New Technology on the Mountainside
Remote and Automation Information

By Ron Wohl

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equipment that you or your electrician can install easily, using "Z Wave" technology. Go to http://www.radopsjacl/com/family/index.isp?categoryId=3249672 to see all the items Radio Shack offers.

Spare keys add-up and if they have identification attached to them, a lost key could mean unauthorized access to your home. Schlage Lock Company now offers several automated digital locks and communicating door locks, thermostats, lighting, and camera systems that you can control from your computer or mobile appliance (iPhone, Blackberry, etc.). You can see these devices at your favorite big box store, amazon, and Schlage.com. Here is a link to Amazon's web page for the Schlage devices: http://www.amazon.com/s/ref=nb_sb_ss_i_7_12?url=search-alias%3Daps&field key-words=schlage+link+system&sprefix=Schlage+link. Schlage says there is a small monthly service fee to receive communications from your system as to which lock codes are being used.

If you want a professional company to wire and set-up your home for remote automation and/or a home theatre, there are several firms you may want to contact starting with Best Buy, Lowes and Home Depot, Lou Clawson in Berkeley Springs (304-258-2738) and others.

While you are thinking of automation and new technology, you may want to avoid the prospect of boiler failure and install a tankless hot water heater and/or radiant heating floor tiles. Research all these suggestions and brands on the internet, then contact one of the big box stores or a local plumber or electrician for more information and the cost of installation in your home.

If you have other technology ideas and links for enjoying our homes on the mountainside, email or call me, Ron Wohl at 301-340-2821 or Ron@WohlComm.Net.



Connect